

LIVE

 Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

11th December, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

50th WEEK



NORTH KOREA...SOLUTION

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.



Learning Space

LIVE



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

11th DECEMBER, 2017

2 A game of chicken in the Korean peninsula - happymon jacob

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878Date :11th December, 2017

On North Korea, the world is way past tactical solutions. Only a comprehensive diplomatic solution will work. Thirteen thousand kilometres. That's how far North Korea's newest Hwasong-15 missile can travel, which puts the United States, its principal adversary, within striking distance. With nuclear capable intercontinental ballistic missiles in its arsenal, and with hardly any workable U.S military options to disarm Pyongyang, nuclear North Korea is now an inevitability and here to stay. Lessons from the tragic end of Saddam Hussein and Muammar Qadhafi would further disincentivise North Korean supreme leader Kim Jong-un to give up his weapons. Pyongyang's neighbours, namely Japan and South Korea, and the international community, the U.S. in particular, however, have not reconciled to this reality provoking a nuclear crisis in the Korean peninsula.

The rationality of escalation

Kim Jong-un has been called all kinds of names, from a ruthless dictator to a madman. But Kim's actions consolidating his hold over power in Pyongyang or developing North Korea's strategic arsenal show that he is anything but irrational. More pertinently, his policy of taking on the entire international community is seemingly premised on the classical military strategy of escalating to de-escalate — to initially escalate to unacceptable levels so as to force one's adversaries to make concessions in areas they otherwise would not. Being recognised as a nuclear weapon capable state would be the foremost objective; survival of his regime and an eventual removal of sanctions would be the natural consequences of such a recognition.

Given that Pyongyang is pursuing such an escalatory strategy when there is a great deal of great power disharmony and American indecisiveness, the odds are heavily stacked in its favour. In this game of chicken, Kim seems to be the winner.

...Contd. 

2 A game of chicken in the Korean peninsula - happymon jacob

...Contd.

Great power buck-passing

Ever since Pyongyang withdrew from the Nuclear Nonproliferation Treaty (NPT) in 2003, which led to the Six-Party Talks to diffuse the situation in the Korean peninsula, the North Korean regime has played the great powers against each other, exploiting their respective strategic calculations vis-à-vis Pyongyang, and each other. Having outmanoeuvred the big boys, North Korea conducted several nuclear tests and has now reached a point of no return, leaving the great powers stupefied and outwitted. Notwithstanding Pyongyang's determination to go down this road by all means, the differing great power endgames and their unwillingness to commit sustained political and diplomatic capital, individually and together, to the Korean peninsula have contributed to the current crisis in a major way.

Today, having exhausted all its strategies, from imposing sanctions to isolating North Korea, Washington has neither any leverage nor is it in a position to make a successful military strike against the country. China is not only worried about a lethal nuclear fallout in its neighbourhood and the potential rush of North Korean refugees into its territory but also uneasy about what may otherwise be an excellent solution — a reunified Korea, something Beijing thinks will undercut its rising regional predominance. Russia, having had clandestine dealings with the North Korean regime in the past, also has no cards to play. And yet, if the unravelling of the Korean peninsula weakens Washington's standing in the region further, Moscow and Beijing would certainly not mind that.

...Contd.



2 A game of chicken in the Korean peninsula

...Contd.

- happymon jacob

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1978

Date :11th December, 2017

Japan and South Korea, in a sense, then are the real victims in this game of great power buck-passing and geopolitical expediency. Seen as arch-rivals by Pyongyang and located in what is arguably the world's most dangerous neighbourhood, Tokyo and Seoul would be the first to face Kim's wrath. What is complicating their plight even more is the shakiness of the extended deterrence commitments of U.S. President Donald Trump's "America First" policy.

Going nuclear would not take too much time or effort for either of these technologically advanced countries. The lack of a firm commitment from Washington on security commitments could potentially prompt them to develop a modest strategic arsenal which would have a domino effect for the region and the rest of the international system. In a self-help world of such kind, the NPT-led non-proliferation regime as we know it would cease to exist.

Systemic crisis

At the heart of it, the crisis in the Korean peninsula reflects an endemic and worrying disorder in the contemporary international system. For one, international diplomacy has failed in the region. The ability of the great powers to compromise and reach a workable consensus to deal with global crises seems to have considerably reduced especially with the arrival of Mr. Trump and the assertion of China and Russia. What is even more worrying is this: the failure of the great powers to arrive at a workable consensus in crisis situations is perhaps a sign of the times to come.

Second, the current crisis is further intensified by the deal-breaking tendencies of Mr. Trump. For instance, his administration's tirade against the Iran nuclear deal, the end result of long, arduous negotiations, is sending out all the wrong signals to the international community. If Kim's North Korea is decidedly revisionist, Mr. Trump's revisionist tendencies are equally damaging.

...Contd. 

2 A game of chicken in the Korean peninsula - happymon jacob

...Contd.

What is also becoming clear today is that isolating states that “misbehave” does not resolve conflicts. Be it Pakistan, Iran or North Korea, isolating states in the international system can only further complicate existing crises. The reason why we have been able to restrain the development of Iranian nuclear weapons is precisely because the P5+1 (China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom, the United States, plus Germany) reached a historic nuclear deal in 2015 despite pressure from within the U.S. and countries such as Israel to use force against Tehran. Had it not been for this deal, we would have had quite a mess in our neighbourhood today.

Finally, and at a deeper level, the disarmament platitudes of the N-5 (or the five nuclear weapon states) and no progress on their disarmament commitments have eroded the faith of the nuclear have-nots in the global nuclear order. In an indirect but relevant way, such erosion of a normative global order has contributed to the North Korean crisis. Therefore, those lamenting how Kim’s nukes will weaken the non-proliferation regime have only themselves to blame for it.

...Contd.

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...Contd.
The future

Now that Pyongyang has crossed the nuclear threshold, international sanctions and the use of force against North Korea will not yield the desired results. It will lead to immeasurable human suffering within North Korea and in its neighbourhood. We are way past tactical solutions, and, therefore, only a comprehensive, sustained and diplomatic solution will work, though the result of which is uncertain, and the intent for which is non-existent among the great powers at this point. However, if indeed Kim is “escalating to deescalate”, Pyongyang might be open to such engagement especially since it has now gone beyond being forcibly disarmed. Moreover, for Kim, talking itself would constitute a form of recognition for his regime.

The most unpleasant part of such a comprehensive solution would involve according de facto “recognition” to North Korea’s nuclear weapons. In other words, North Korea has nuclear weapons and its delivery mechanism in its custody, and there is no getting away from that fact, not now. If so, all we can do now is to consider how we can live with a nuclear North Korea rather than think of impractical military solutions to disarm Pyongyang. For sure, it would be a pity to add it to the list of states possessing nuclear weapons. But then there is a time to prevent something from becoming a reality, and there is a time to accept when it becomes an inevitable reality.

The operational aspect of this approach would involve taking on board North Korea’s historical grievances, involving the regional powers including China and South Korea to reach out to Kim, and reviving the dormant Six Party Talks at the earliest. Revival of the Six Party talks is important precisely because entrusting China and or Russia to solely deal with North Korea would be unwise. Moreover, multilateral engagement would also prevent anyone from engaging in underhand dealings with Pyongyang.



Sabre-rattling

Direct talks are the only way out to de-escalate the crisis in the Korean peninsula

North Korea's adventurism continues unabated. On Sunday, it tested what it claims was a "hydrogen bomb", its sixth nuclear weapons test, cocking a snook at non-proliferation and international test ban laws, as well as at U.S. President Donald Trump. Even as the tests drew global condemnation, this was clearly a response to Mr. Trump's sabre-rattling rhetoric claiming that the U.S. would rain "fire and fury" over the country and implying that its nuclear weapons were "locked and loaded" to respond to any threat from North Korea. Mr. Trump's response to Sunday's development was to ratchet up threats, besides calling out U.S. ally South Korea for "appeasement" and threatening to cut trade ties with countries that conduct any form of business with the North Koreans. Clearly the tough talk is not working – it is only pushing North Korea's totalitarian regime to take even more provocative steps in a quest to attain the status of a *de facto* nuclear power. In response to the exacerbated tensions in the region, South Korea and Japan have significantly enhanced their defence capabilities, including spending on missile defence. South Korea's new President Moon Jae-in, who is in favour of talks, has now accepted the U.S.'s missile defence system, THAAD, which is opposed locally by many South Koreans.

North Korea relies on increasing militarisation and show of missile and nuclear prowess for various reasons. Part of its ploy is to convince its impoverished and isolated citizenry of the need for the country to attain military parity in light of the presence of the U.S. military shield in South Korea and Japan. Another part of it is to justify the years of the Kim family rule, as these tests add to the myth of strong leadership by its 33-year-old,

EDITORIAL DISCUSSION ON 5th September, 2017

IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

China is in a position to silence North Korea and China is not doing so for its strategic reasons. Direct talks appears to be the best option to de-escalate the conflict. Explain your view point?

Date: 5th September, 2017

CURRENT AFFAIRS



**NORTH KOREA
& USA
WHAT NEXT ?**



18th WEEK 2017

UPSC

CAPSULE - 3

ALL EXAMS

1st May to 7th May, 2017



ABOUT NORTH KOREA

LIVE

- Name is Democratic People's Republic of Korea
- Capital Pyongyang
- Language ... Korean
- Currency ... Won
- Population ... 25 million
- It is in East Asia
- It has got land boundary with 3 countries i.e., China, Russia & South Korea
- Armistice of 1953 ended armed conflict in Korean peninsula

HEADS / SUPREME LEADERS



KIM II-SUNG
(1948-1994)



KIM JONG-IL
(1994-2011)



KIM JONG-UN
(since 2011)





RUSSIA

MONGOLIA

NORTH KOREA

Korea bay

Sea of Japan

North Pacific Ocean

South Korea

Yellow Sea

JAPAN

CHINA

East China Sea

2

A game of chicken in the Korean peninsula

On North Korea, the world is wary of tactical solutions. Only a comprehensive diplomatic solution will work

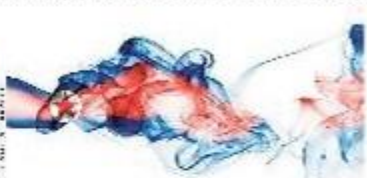


Harpreet Kaur

The world's attention has been fixed on North Korea's nuclear programme, which sits at the heart of the United States' principal foreign policy. North Korea's nuclear programme is a game of chicken, and will likely stay volatile for many years. The United States' policy on North Korea is one of uncertainty and fear. It is not clear how far the United States will go to deter North Korea from developing nuclear weapons. The United States' policy on North Korea is one of uncertainty and fear. It is not clear how far the United States will go to deter North Korea from developing nuclear weapons.

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There are many reasons why the United States is so concerned about North Korea's nuclear programme. One of the main reasons is that North Korea's nuclear programme could threaten the security of the United States and its allies in the region. Another reason is that North Korea's nuclear programme could threaten the stability of the Korean peninsula.



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Great power balancing act

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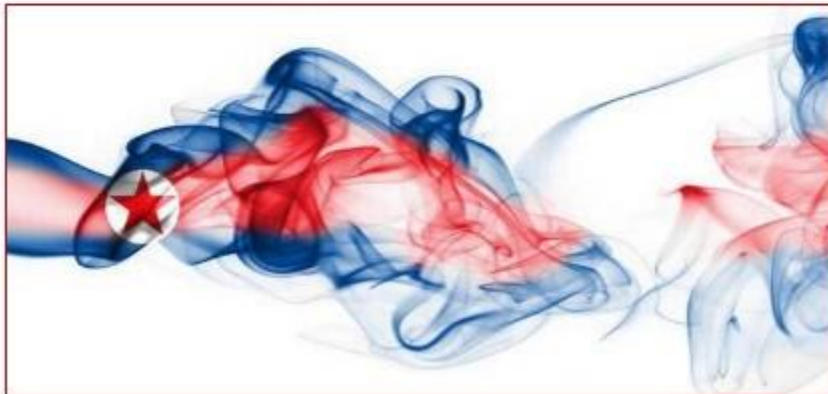
IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

Examine the present scenario of nuclear capability of North Korea and indicate the steps required to solve the crisis.

GAME OF CHICKEN

- 1 It is the contest with two players, where neither one wants to back-down.
- 2 “Chicken” in this usage means “Coward”.
- 3 It is a dangerous test of, who will yield first.



INTERCONTINENTAL BALLISTIC MISSILE

- 1 It is a guided ballistic missile with a minimum range of 5,500 kms.
- 2 It is designed primarily for nuclear weapons delivery.



NEWS REPORT

North Korea successfully launched Hwasong-15, which is a nuclear capable Intercontinental Ballistic Missile (ICBM).

SALIENT POINTS

- It can reach entire eastern US seaboard including Washington.
- It indicates that the progress is made by North Korea in developing a Weapon of Mass Destruction.
- The missile has more than 13,000 kms range, which covers all of Earth's continents except South America and Antarctica.
- ICBM is missile launched by land-based system that is intended to carry nuclear payloads.



North Korea will be 8th nation in the world to successfully test ICBM. Other countries that have ICBM technology are US, Russia, China, UK, France, Israel and India.



Dr. A Q Khan



NUCLEAR TECHNOLOGY TO NORTH KOREA ... SUSPICION ON PAKISTAN

- 1** We have to go back to North Korea's uranium nuclear weapons programme of 1990s.
- 2** It was developed with the substantial help from Dr. A Q Khan, the Pakistani scientist associated with Pakistan's nuclear weapons programme.
- 3** Subsequently, there were official agreements between the two countries, under which North Korea provided ballistic missile technologies to Pakistan in exchange for the help of the nuclear programme.
- 4** It was also reported that Benazir Bhutto was personally involved in finalising this exchange deal with Pyongyang during her official visit to North Korea in December 1993.



WHAT WENT WRONG SINCE 2000?



- 1** The Bush administration declared North Korea as part of the 'Axis of Evil' in 2002.
- 2** It also cancelled direct talks and annulled 1994 agreement.
- 3** North Korea responded by throwing out International Atomic Energy Agency inspectors and formally leaving the Non-Proliferation Treaty, thereby provoking a fresh crisis.
- 4** China and Russia initiated Six Party Talks in 2004, which led to the 2005 joint statement, which expanded the scope to more than the nuclear issue.
- 5** However, the talks collapsed when the U.S. imposed sanctions a few months later.
- 6** North Korea responded with its first nuclear test in 2006.



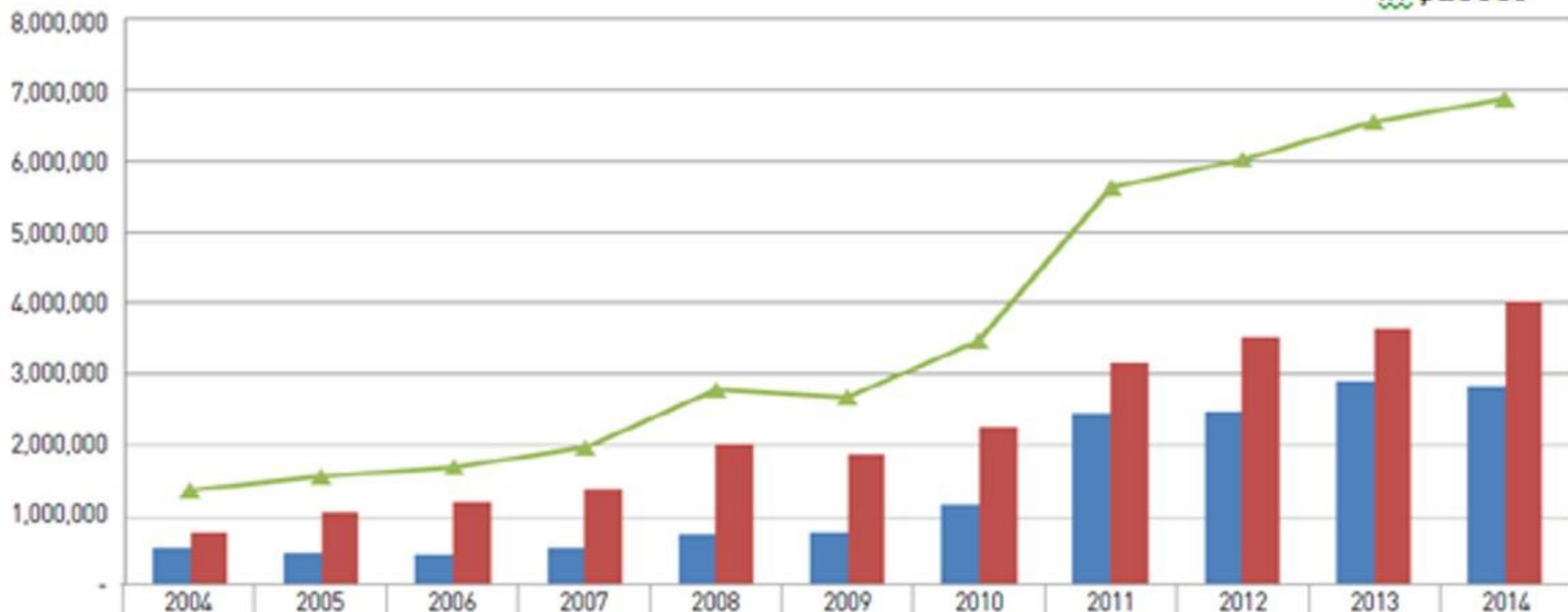
IAEA

International Atomic Energy Agency

EDITORIAL DISCUSSION

North Korea-China Trade

in \$1000s



Exports
Imports
Total

수출
수입
수출입계

	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014
Exports	585,703	499,157	467,718	581,521	754,046	793,048	1,187,861	2,464,188	2,484,699	2,913,624	2,841,476
Imports	799,503	1,081,184	1,231,886	1,392,453	2,033,233	1,887,686	2,277,816	3,165,181	3,527,843	3,632,909	4,022,515
Total	1,385,206	1,580,341	1,699,604	1,973,974	2,787,279	2,680,734	3,465,677	5,629,369	6,012,542	6,546,533	6,863,991



HWASONG-15



- 1 It is the first ever launch of the largest and the most powerful Ballistic Missile by North Korea.
- 2 It is North Korea's second ever liquid-fueled Intercontinental-range Ballistic Missile designed to see flight testing.
- 3 The North Korea said, ICBM is tipped with super-large heavy warhead.
- 4 It also claimed that the missile could strike the whole mainland of the United States of America.
- 5 U.S. may think of installing Terminal High Altitude Area Defence (THAAD) batteries towards two sides on the west-coast to protect against attack by North Korean Intercontinental Ballistic Missiles.
- 6 The United States already has Ground-Based Midcourse Defence System with sites at Alaska and California.
- 7 They can fire huge missiles to intercept ICBMs in Space.



HWASONG-15



NORTH KOREA ... THE PRESENT REALITY AND STRATEGY

1 North Korea has gone to a point of no return.

2 The Country is adopting classical military strategy of escalating to de-escalate.

3 In this process, it will ask for several concessions.

4 The foremost objective is to recognize it as a “nuclear weapon capable state”.

5 Survival of the Regime and eventual removal of Sanctions would be the natural consequences.

6 North Korean Regime has played the great powers against each other.





SEE THE GREAT POWER GAME!

- 1 China does not want unified Korea.
- 2 Now the options of United States of America are very much limited.
- 3 Japan and South Korea are the real victims in this Game of Great Power Struggle.
- 4 These two countries are the arch-rivals for Pyongyang and they are located in the world's most dangerous neighbourhood.

**DONALD TRUMP**

HOW CAN WE INFER THIS?

- 1 It is the failure of the International Diplomacy.
- 2 The ability of the great powers to compromise and reach a workable consensus to deal with global crisis reduced, more so, after the arrival of Donald Trump.
- 3 Mr. Donald Trump is known as deal-breaker.
- 4 It is a clear message that isolating the states that misbehave does not resolve the conflicts.
- 5 Nuclear Weapon States talk about disarmament, but no progress on their disarmament commitments and it eroded the faith of the nuclear have-nots in the global nuclear order.

NORTH KOREA ISSUE ... FUTURE SCENARIO

- 1** China cannot permit a regime collapse, because of strategic reasons.
- 2** As South Korea is a close ally of USA, if North Korea collapses, then North Korea may be subsumed into unified Korea, which will not be palatable for China.
- 3** Quite often, China says that the U.S. and South Korea should suspend their military exercises.
- 4** China is worried about the possibility of an unpredictable Trump initiating unilateral action, which could create an escalatory spiral.
- 5** China is also not happy with the U.S. decision to accelerate deployment of the THAAD (Terminal High Altitude Area Defence) missile defence system.



FINAL WORD

1 More sanctions or military strikes cannot be the option.

2 Dialogue is the only option.

3 Denuclearisation of the Korean peninsula should be a long-term objective.

4 At least for the time being, world community should make North Korea to agree to a freeze on its nuclear programmes.

5 US needs to provide assurances relating to regime acceptance and a gradual normalization of relations.

6 The regional powers, China and South Korea must be involved to reach out to Kim. Reviving the dormant Six Party Talks at the earliest is very important.

Mr. Jong-un's stakes are existential in nature, having seen Western interventions in Iraq and Libya and Russian intervention in Ukraine. So, it is necessary to tackle the problem with utmost delicacy.

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